The assignment model: one hierarchy, every vendor mapped onto it

Our domain is fixed. Adapters translate each platform into it; terminology, outcome scope and capabilities are data on the connection preset, never branches in the UI.

Customer

The person. Many assignments over time.

1 : many

Assignment

The unit of work the agent is handed and the unit that gets outcomed.

Owns: status · disposition · tags · summary · NBA queue · reference column · Real-Time Summary

Keys: `assignmentId`, `externalId` (vendor case/contact/conversation id)

Outcome lives here

An assignment is made of parts. Two kinds:

Leg (Interaction — one channel session)

voice · chat · email · SMS · WhatsApp · social DM

Owns: start/end · duration · hold · recording · transfer · after-call work (the vendor's clock) · address

Keys: `interactionId`, `externalId`

ACW lives here

per-leg disposition: optional

Work item (a part that isn't a conversation)

callback (P0.9) · submit a payment · update a ticket · approve a request · run a flow · scheduled follow-up

Owns: kind · status · due/scheduled · result

Keys: `workItemId`, `kind`

Rendered in the same card shell with a kind icon (Phase 7 §2).

Message / utterance

text · html · media · interactive · transcript turn. Keyed to the leg.

Adapter boundary

Every platform is translated INTO this model by its adapter. The adapter declares what it can do; a connection preset seeds the settings that shape the UI:

`capabilities.outcomeScope`	assignment | leg | both
`capabilities.assignment.split / merge`	
`terms.assignment / terms.leg`	vendor vocabulary
`dispositions · notReadyReasons`	imported lists

Proven by the contract suite: an adapter is done only when it passes the outcome section for the scopes it declares.

Outcome scope → the Outcome form

assignment: one form; legs inherit.

both: one form, fans out to legs; a collapsed "applies to all N channels · change" row allows per-leg overrides.

leg: one form per channel (today's behaviour), for vendors with no grouping.

Two rules that never vary

ACW runs per leg, on the leg's end. The outcome is due when the last leg closes, or when the agent closes the assignment early.

Why the assignment is the primary noun

The nav card already groups a customer's channels, `caseId` / `journeyId` already key the group, `setCaseStatus` is case-level and the callback `WorkItem` (P0.9) is an assignment part that isn't a conversation. Naming it makes the NBA, the summaries and the Outcome attach to the right thing.

What a vendor can change

- The words (terminology preset, overridable per tenant).
- Whether the Outcome form writes once, fans out, or repeats per channel.
- Which verbs exist (split, merge, transfer the assignment vs. a leg).
- Where dispositions and not-ready reasons come from.

What a vendor cannot change

- The hierarchy itself.
- ACW per leg; outcome per assignment (with fan-out).
- Reporting events: leg events always, one assignment outcome event.
- One agent UI; no vendor-specific screens.

Platforms we haven't met yet

Nothing here is vendor-specific. An unknown platform gets the **Generic** preset (our defaults), the adapter author fills a mapping table (the same shape as page 2) through Connector Mappings, declares capabilities, and runs the contract suite. If it has no grouping concept, the adapter synthesises one assignment per leg; if it has one we don't, it maps it to an assignment and the rest to legs. The setup assistant can draft the mapping from the vendor's API docs.

Vendor mapping

Typical terms per platform; exact names vary by product line and version. The right-hand columns show how the connection preset would be seeded. Treat unfamiliar vendors as the Generic column until the adapter is written.

Ours	NICE CXone	Genesys Cloud	Salesforce Service Cloud (Omni-Channel)	Amazon Connect	Twilio Flex	Zendesk	Five9 / Talkdesk / 8×8 (dialer-style)	Generic / unknown
Assignment `assignmentId`	Digital: **Case** (groups digital contacts). Voice: no grouping — adapter synthesises one assignment per contact, merges by customer when the agent adds a channel.	**Conversation** (spans channels and participants)	**Case** (or Work Item when no case is opened)	No native grouping; **Case** (Connect Cases) when enabled, else synthesised; related-contact chains link legs	Flex Conversations **Interaction**; otherwise synthesised from Tasks	**Ticket**	Usually none; synthesised. Five9: campaign-level grouping only	Synthesised: one per leg, merged by customer
Leg `interactionId`	**Contact** (one per ACD channel session)	**Communication** (call, chat, message, email)	**Voice Call**, **Messaging Session**, Email message; routed as **Agent Work**	**Contact** (voice, chat, task)	**Task** (TaskRouter)	Talk call; messaging conversation; email thread on the ticket	**Interaction** / **Call**; 8×8: Interaction	Interaction
Work item `workItemId · kind`	Digital case action; WEM task; callback (Personal Connection)	Callback; Work item (Genesys Task Management)	Task; Flow step; Omni-routed custom object	**Task** contact type	Task with a non-channel channel	Ticket task / trigger	Callback; scheduled call	Work item
Customer `customerId`	Customer card (Digital) / CRM record via integration	External Contact	Contact / Person Account	Customer Profile	Conversations Participant + CRM	End user	Contact record	Customer
Skill / queue `skill`	Skill	Queue (+ skills, language)	Queue (+ skills)	Queue (+ routing profile)	Workflow / TaskQueue	Group	Skill / Ring group / Queue	Skill
Disposition `dispositions (admin data)`	**Disposition** per contact; tags	**Wrap-up code** per participant communication	Call disposition (Voice); case status/reason	Contact attributes; Case status	Custom task attributes	Ticket status + tags/custom fields	**Disposition** (strong, native); 8×8: Transaction code	Our list
After-call work `per leg, always`	After Contact Work (ACW) state	After Call Work	After Conversation Work	After Contact Work	"Wrapping" task state	None native (ticket stays open)	After Call Work / Wrap-up	Wrap-up
Not-ready reasons `notReadyReasons (admin data)`	Unavailable codes	Secondary presence / routing status	Presence status	Agent status	Worker activity	Agent status (Talk)	Not Ready reason codes	Our list
Outcome scope `capabilities.outcomeScope`	`both` fan out to each contact	`both` wrap-up per communication	`both` case + voice disposition	`leg` (`both` with Cases)	`leg`	`assignment`	`leg`	`assignment`
Split / merge `capabilities.assignment.*`	Merge only (Digital cases); no split	Both (conversation can be split by participant)	Merge cases; split by creating a case	Neither native	Neither native	Merge tickets; split	Neither	Hidden until declared
Terminology preset `terms.*`	Assignment → **Contact** (digital: Case); Leg → Channel; Skill → Skill	Assignment → **Conversation**; Leg → Interaction; Skill → Queue	Assignment → **Case** / Work Item; Skill → Queue	Assignment → **Contact**; Skill → Queue	Assignment → **Task**; Skill → Queue	Assignment → **Ticket**; Skill → Group	Assignment → **Interaction**/Call; Skill → Skill/Queue	Assignment · Leg · Skill (ours)

Outcome scope: `assignment` one Outcome, legs inherit `both` one Outcome that fans out, per-leg override available `leg` one Outcome per channel (today's behaviour) `n/a` not applicable

Vendor terms are from public product documentation as generally understood; verify against the specific product line and API version when an adapter is written. The mapping table is the same shape an adapter author fills in Connector Mappings, so an unknown platform is a new column, not a new design.